Work Board — Phase 1 plan

One board. Managers assign and review; team members execute.

Ati Motors · Internal · 14 October 2026 · Status: **Draft for review** · Supersedes the 12 October Phase 1 proposal

1. Summary

We are building a single internal Kanban board for durable task tracking across a reporting line. A manager assigns work to their reports and reviews it. A team member sees the work assigned to them and moves it forward. The reporting line comes from Keka (read-only) and decides *whose tasks you can see*; it is not the permission system itself.

What changed from the 12 October proposal

- **Managers assign; members can add their own.** A member can create tasks for themselves only. A task a member creates carries a **Self-created** badge that managers can see. Tasks a manager assigns are executed by the member.
- **Managers own what they assign.** A manager can edit, move, accept, send back and reopen tasks they created, and the self-created tasks of people in their team; tasks another manager created for their report are visible but read-only. Every action is logged in the task timeline with their name. **Admin is a sudo user**: access to everything, with a Team filter.
- **Manager-verified completion.** A new *Review* column: on manager-assigned tasks, members submit and the manager accepts (Done) or sends back with a reason. Self-created tasks skip review.
- **Reasons are mandatory** when a task is Blocked, sent back or reopened, and live in a per-task timeline.
- **Overdue is a calculated flag**, not a column. **Red** stays a manual at-risk flag, set by the member or their manager.
- **Manager is derived** (at least one active report in Keka), or granted by an admin.
- **Scope is explicit:** direct reports by default, indirect reports behind a toggle.
- **Slack alerts are Phase 2.** Phase 1 notifies in-app only: review inbox, Returned badge, header counts.
- **Fresh build.** New branch, frontend first against mock data; none of the earlier branch is reused.

2. Why Keka is the scope, not the RBAC

Concern with Keka-as-RBAC	How this plan handles it
HR tree is not the work tree; work crosses departments	Known Phase 1 limit. Tasks assigned across reporting lines are visible only to the assignee, their management chain and admins. Because this is organization-wide, cross-department work will be common. A follow-up (cross-team assignment or sharing) is the likely next step.
Full-depth visibility is too broad	Direct reports by default; indirect reports behind an explicit toggle.
Sync lag after reorgs and exits	Daily sync plus admin "Sync now"; deactivated people's open tasks are flagged *needs reassignment* and the manager sees a banner.
Bad or missing Keka data	Audited manual override of manager; a failed sync keeps the last good hierarchy.
Permissions tied to org chart changes	Permissions depend on role (member, manager of the assignee, admin) and on the task's assignee and creator. Keka only answers "who are my reports?".

3. Roles and permissions

Three roles. A manager acts on **tasks they created** and on the **self-created tasks of people in their team**. Tasks another manager created for their report are visible but read-only. An admin can act on anything.

Action	Team member	Manager (own scope)	Admin (sudo)
Create a task	**For self only (badged Self-created)**	**For self or any report in scope**	**For anyone**
Edit title, assignee, priority, due date, Red; delete	Their own self-created tasks (assignee stays self)	Tasks they created, and members' self-created tasks in their scope	Any task
Move status	Tasks assigned to them; Done only on their own self-created tasks	Tasks they created and members' self-created tasks in scope, any move (accept, send back, reopen); logged. Tasks assigned to them: as assignee	Any task, any move; logged
Reopen a Done task	Their own self-created tasks	Tasks they created, and members' self-created tasks in scope	Any task
View	Tasks assigned to them	Own tasks + all tasks of reports (direct; indirect by toggle), read-only unless they created it or it is self-created	**Every task, org-wide**
Filters	Red, Overdue, Due this week	+ Person, Blocked, Self-created, Needs my review	+ **Team** filter
Scope switcher	**Not shown**	My work | My team	All tasks with Team and Person filters
Access management (UAM)	**No**	**No**	**Yes**

Every action is logged in the task. When a manager or admin edits a member's task or moves its status, the entry in the task's timeline records who did it, what changed, and the reason where one is required. The member can open the task and see it.

Creator. Recorded once and never changes. It makes a task *Self-created* (creator = assignee), lets a member edit their own self-created tasks, and identifies which manager owns a manager-assigned task.

Edge rules. A member can assign a task only to themselves; a manager only to themselves or people in their scope; an admin to anyone. A self-created task skips Review: the member can move it straight to Done, and the member's manager can edit or reopen it. If the creating manager leaves, loses the manager role, or the assignee moves to a different manager, the assignee's current manager (or an admin) can take ownership of the task.

4. Who sees what

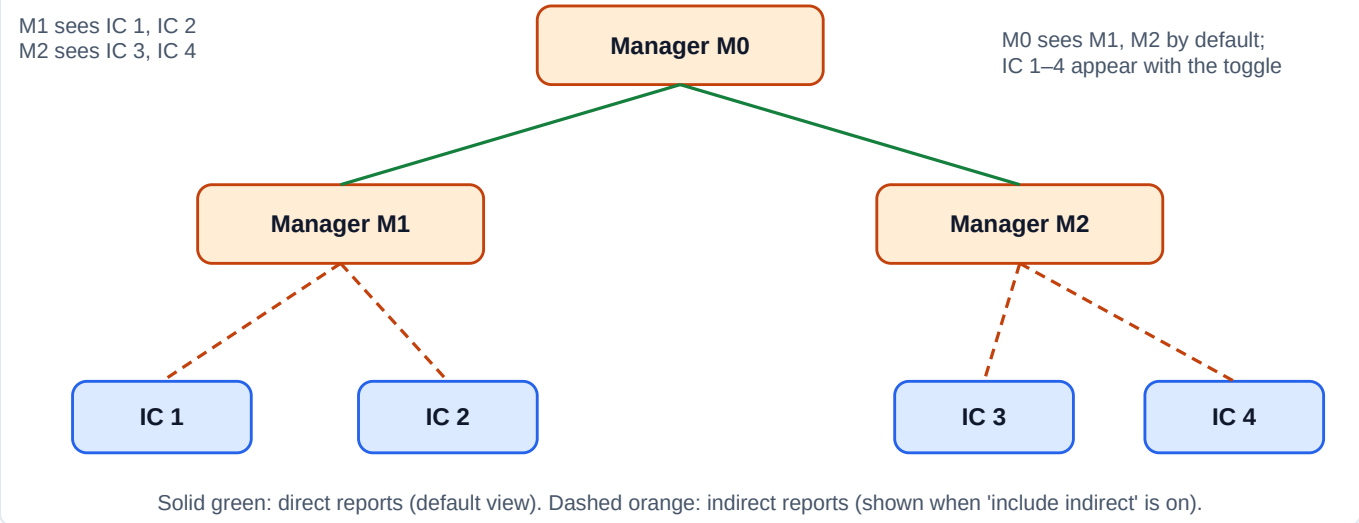


Figure 1. Visibility follows the reporting line. Direct reports by default; indirect reports behind a toggle.

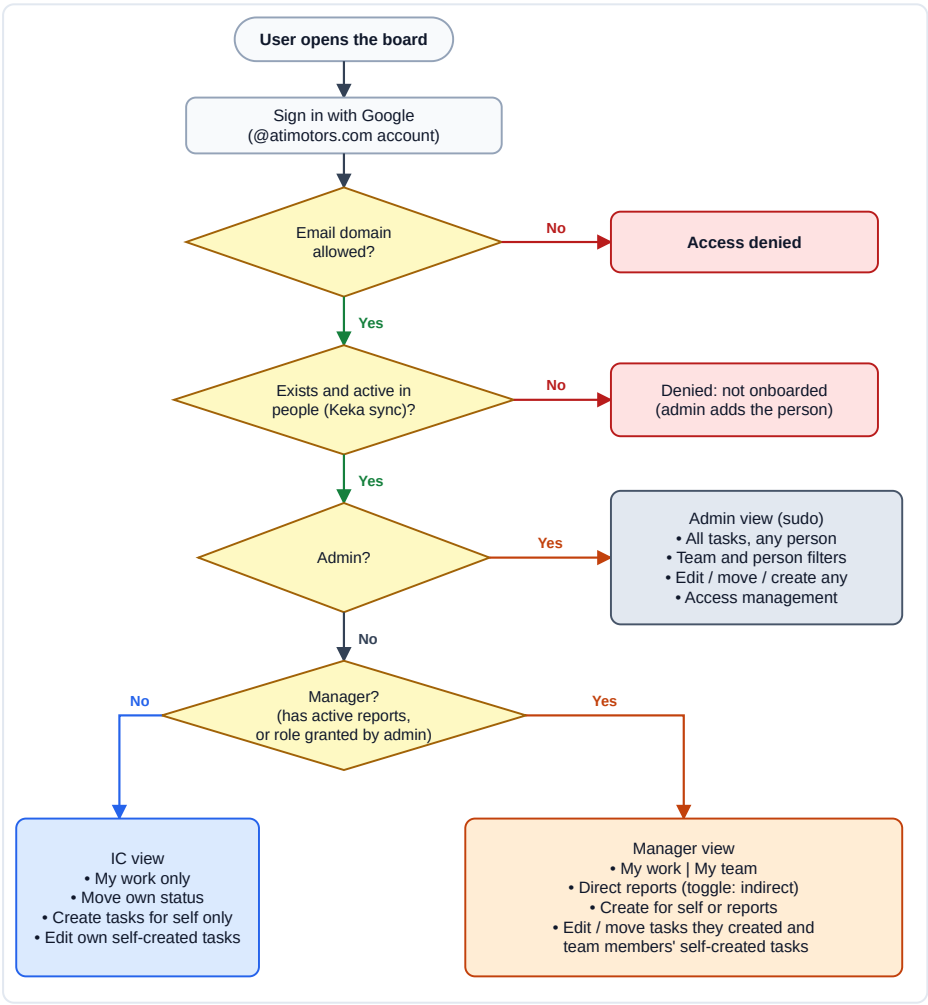


Figure 2. Sign-in and view resolution. 'Manager' is derived from Keka (at least one active direct report) or granted by an admin.

5. Task lifecycle

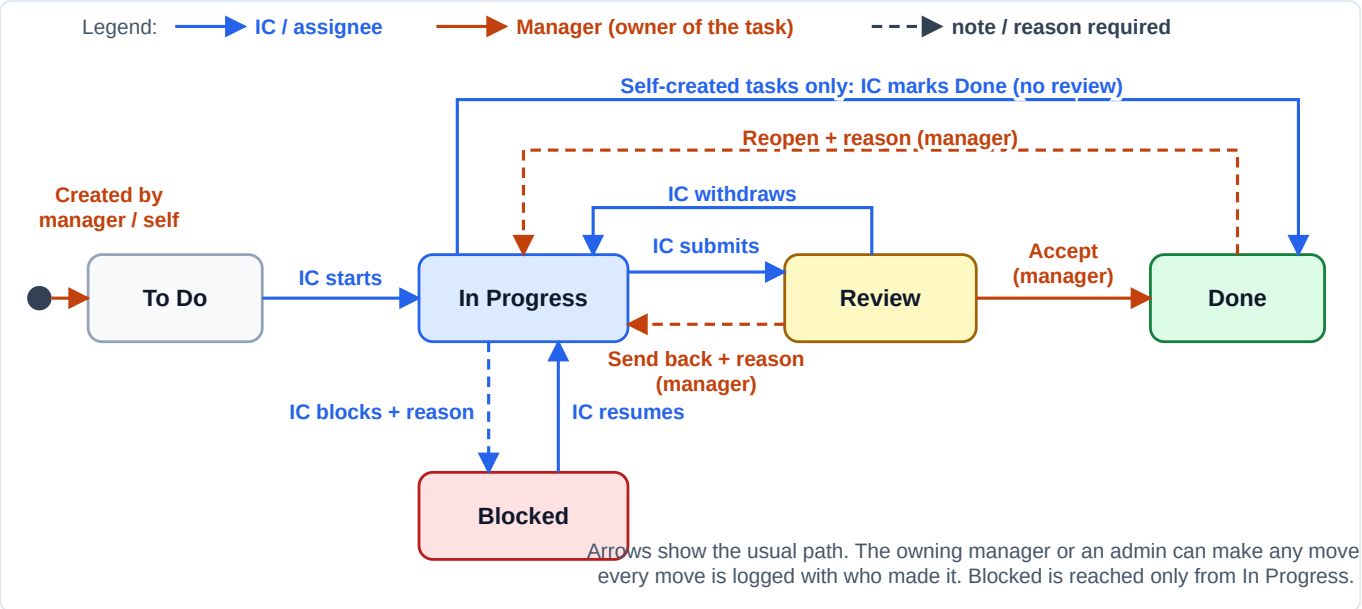


Figure 3. Status model. The assignee moves work forward; a manager accepts, sends back or reopens. Dashed transitions require a written reason.

The owning manager (the task's creator, or the member's manager for a self-created task) and admins can make any of these moves. Each move is logged with who made it, and the member can see this in the task timeline.

Transition	Usual actor	Reason required
(create) → To Do	Manager, or member for self	No
To Do → In Progress	Assignee	No
In Progress → Blocked	Assignee	**Yes**
Blocked → In Progress	Assignee	No
In Progress → Review	Assignee	No
Review → In Progress (withdraw)	Assignee	No
Review → Done (accept)	Manager	No
In Progress → Done (self-created tasks only)	Assignee	No
Review → In Progress (send back)	Manager	**Yes**
Done → In Progress (reopen)	Manager (member on own self-created)	**Yes**

Overdue and Red

- **Overdue** is calculated: due date before today and status not Done. Shown as a badge, a filter, and sorted to the top of its column. Nothing is stored, so it cannot go stale.
- **Due soon** highlights tasks due within 2 days.
- **Red** is a manual flag meaning "at risk", set by the member or their manager. It is independent of the due date.

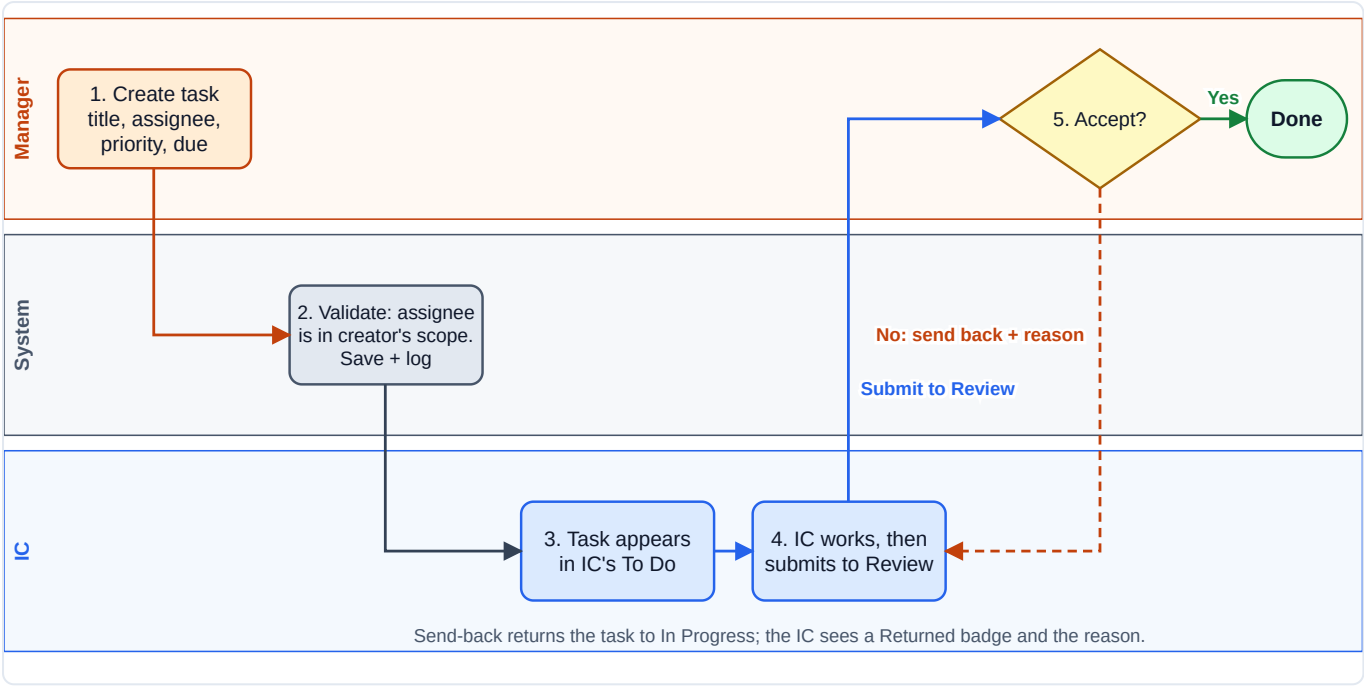


Figure 4. End-to-end flow of a manager-assigned task, including the send-back loop. A self-created task skips the manager and Review: the member creates it, works it and marks it Done.

6. Task detail and history

Opening a card shows the task fields and an append-only timeline. Every status change, field edit, reassignment and reason is a timeline entry with actor and timestamp. Reasons for Blocked, send-back and reopen are stored with the entry that required them. Nobody can edit or delete history. Free-form comments are deliberately out of Phase 1; they are an easy follow-up (a new entry type in the same timeline).

Card shows	Detail panel adds
Title, assignee (in team view), priority, due date, Red / Overdue / Due-soon badges, latest Blocked or send-back reason, "returned ×N" counter	Description, created-by, full timeline, Edit (manager, admin, or the member on their own self-created task), Accept / Send back (in Review), Reopen (in Done)

7. Manager and admin views

- **Acts on tasks they own:** tasks they created and team members' self-created tasks. Edit, reassign, move status, accept, send back and reopen are available there, and their moves carry their name in the task timeline. Other managers' tasks for their reports are shown read-only with "assigned by <manager>".
- **Tabs:** My work | My team, with a person filter and an "include indirect reports" toggle.
- **Filters:** Red, Overdue, Blocked, **Self-created**, and *Needs my review* (the manager's inbox).
- **Team strip:** per-person open / overdue / blocked counts above the board.
- **Orphan banner:** tasks of deactivated people flagged *needs reassignment*.
- **Activity:** "moved this week" feed from the timeline.

Team member view: one board of their own tasks, same five columns, each card showing "assigned by <manager>" or a **Self-created** badge. An **Add task** button creates a task assigned to themselves; there is no assignee choice. Done cards leave the board after about 7 days.

Admin view: every task org-wide, with **Team** and **Person** filters plus all the manager filters, and per-team open / overdue / blocked counts in the team strip. An admin can create, edit, move and reassign anything; actions are logged with the admin's name.

8. Notifications

Phase 1 is in-app only. Nothing is pushed; people see what needs them when they open the board. Slack alerts are Phase 2.

Event	Phase 1: where it shows
Member submits to Review	Manager's *Needs my review* filter, with a count badge in the header
Manager sends a task back	Member sees a *Returned* badge and the reason on the card, with a count badge in the header
Task marked Red, Blocked or overdue	Card badges; Red, Blocked and Overdue filters; per-person counts in the manager's team strip
Person deactivated or left	Manager's orphan banner (*needs reassignment*)
Keka sync failed	Admin banner in Access management

Phase 2: Slack DMs

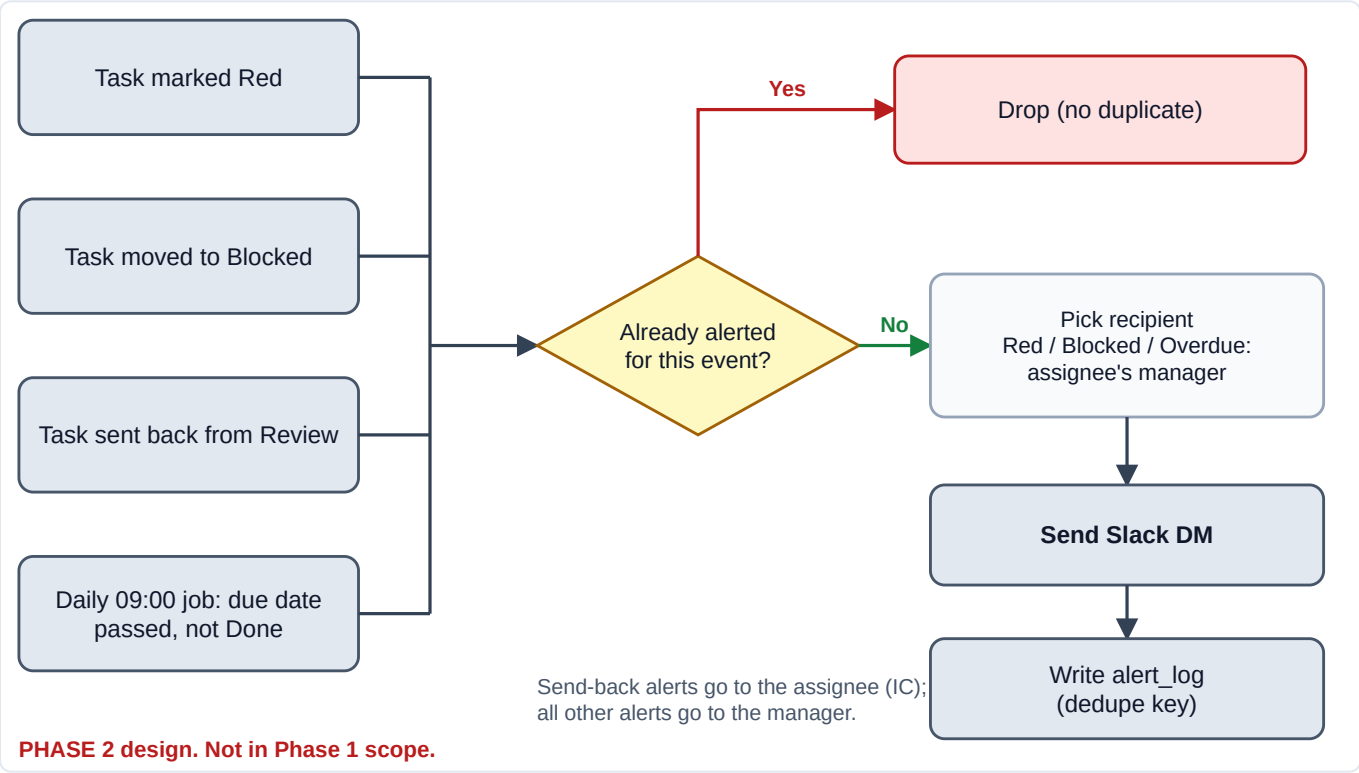


Figure 5. Phase 2 alert pipeline. Each event alerts once; a daily job picks up tasks that newly became overdue. Overdue itself needs no job in Phase 1 because it is calculated.

Event (Phase 2)	Recipient
Task marked Red	Assignee's manager (DM)
Task moved to Blocked	Assignee's manager (DM)
Task became overdue	Assignee's manager (DM)
Task sent back from Review	Assignee (DM)

Phase 2 alerts will link to the task detail panel. No scheduled digests are planned.

9. Keka hierarchy sync

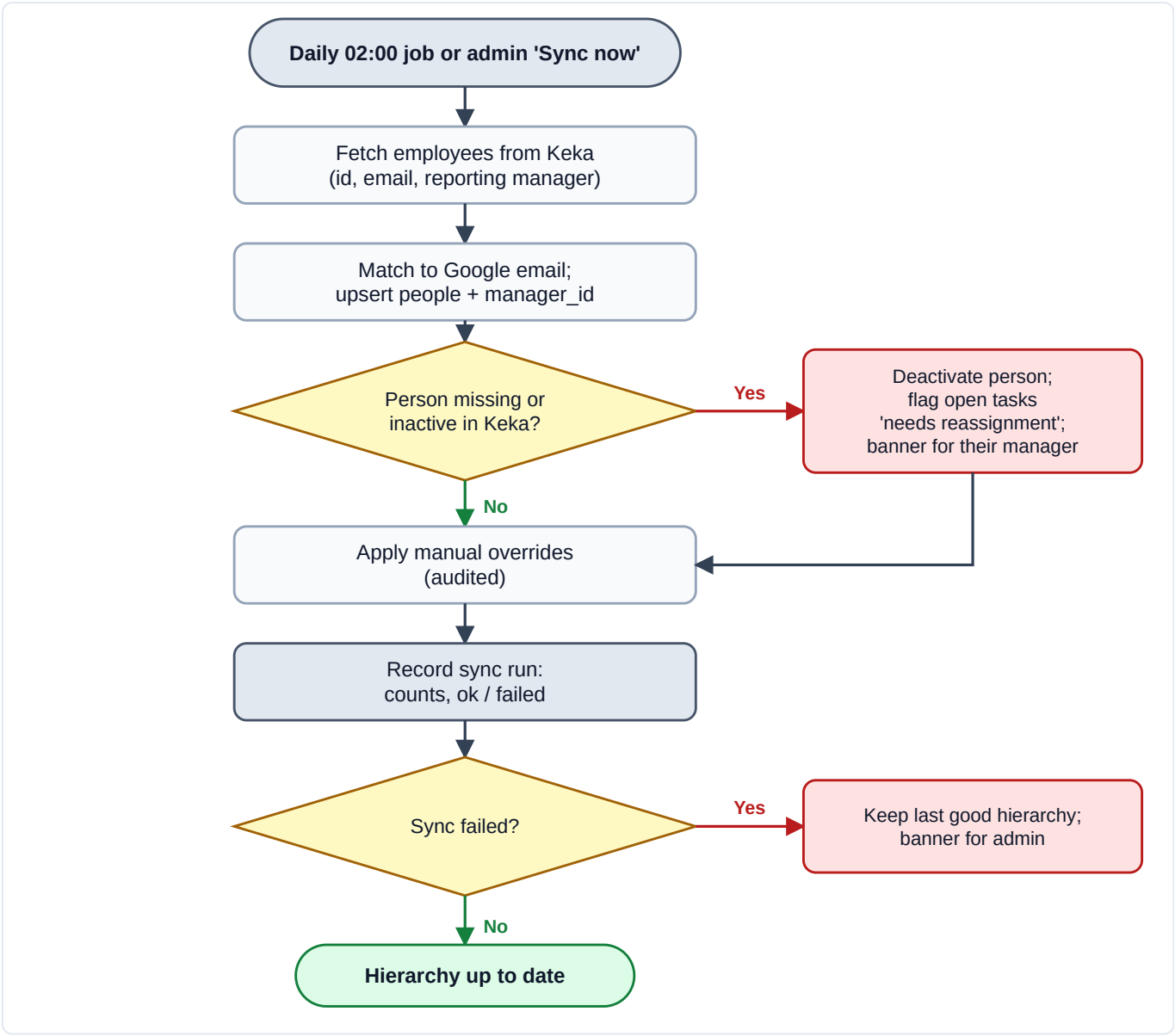


Figure 6. Read-only sync of the reporting line. Attendance and leave APIs are not used.

The sync reads each employee's reporting manager. **Teams come from the same data**: a team is a manager and their reports. If Keka also exposes a team or department field, it can be used as the team's label (to be confirmed against your Keka account). Admins can override both.

10. Admin and access management (UAM)

Keka supplies the default hierarchy; admins correct it and manage access from one **Access management** screen. Teams come from Keka (a manager and their reports, with a team or department label if Keka provides one), so there is no separate team list to maintain; admins can override membership. **Admin is a sudo user:** any action on any task is allowed and logged with the admin's name.

Admin can	Detail
Override the reporting manager	Fixes missing or wrong Keka data. Wins over the synced value and survives later syncs.
Manage teams	Move a person to another manager or team, add people not in Keka (contractors, interns), deactivate or reactivate.
Change roles	Grant or revoke **manager** (for a new lead whose reports are not in Keka yet), and grant or revoke **admin**.
Review	See every override, every role grant, and entries where Keka now disagrees with an override.

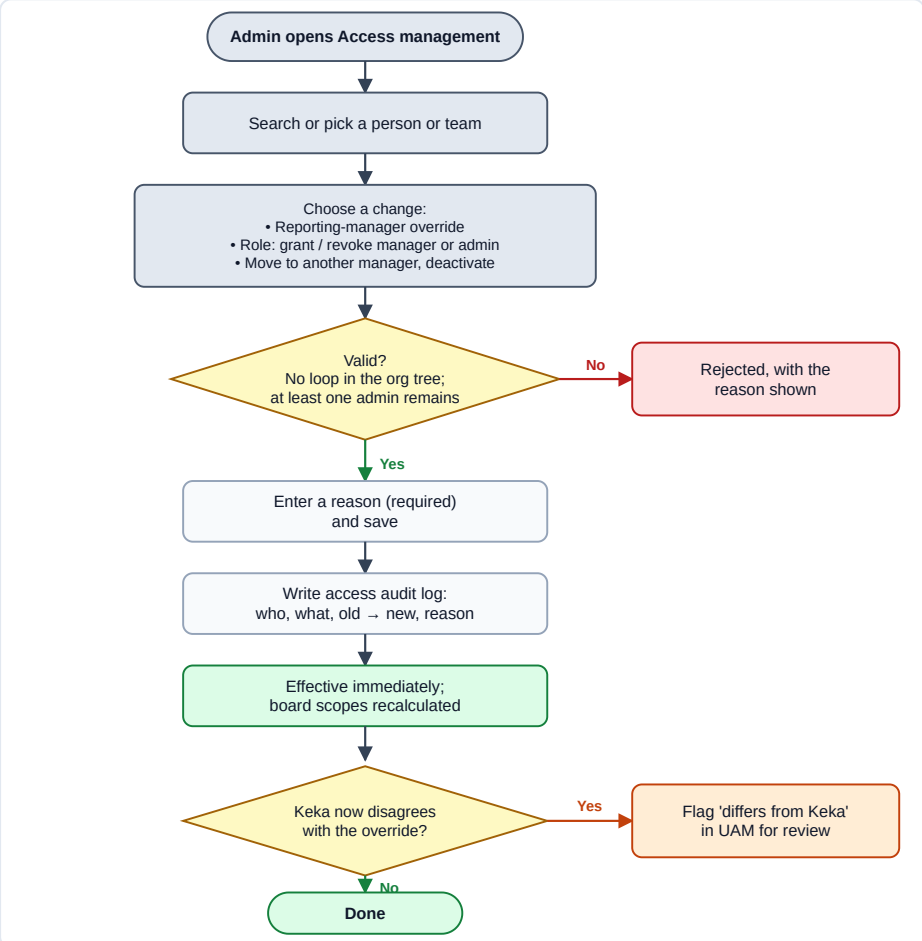


Figure 7. Admin change flow. Every change is validated, needs a reason, is logged, and takes effect immediately.

Safeguards: a change cannot create a reporting loop; at least one admin must always remain; every change has a required reason and an audit entry; admin edits are recorded in the task timeline, never hidden, and history entries themselves cannot be edited or deleted. Existing tasks keep their creator and assignee when a reporting line changes; only *who can see them* changes.